Day 2 — Wazuh SIEM Dashboarding & Windows Security Event Analysis

Date: August 24, 2026

Objective

Move beyond single-alert analysis and start building a reusable security monitoring dashboard in Wazuh, while going deeper into the specific Windows Security Event IDs used for account management monitoring.

1. Dashboard Creation

Built a custom Wazuh dashboard ("Failed Windows Logon") combining four visualizations to get a consolidated view of activity across the lab:

- **Win-Failed_logon** — Single-stat count of failed Windows logon events
- **Alerts-Over-Time** — Time-series trend of total alert volume across the environment
- **Alerts by Severity** — Bar chart of alert count grouped by rule.level, showing severity distribution
- **Alerts by Agent** — Bar chart comparing alert volume generated per agent

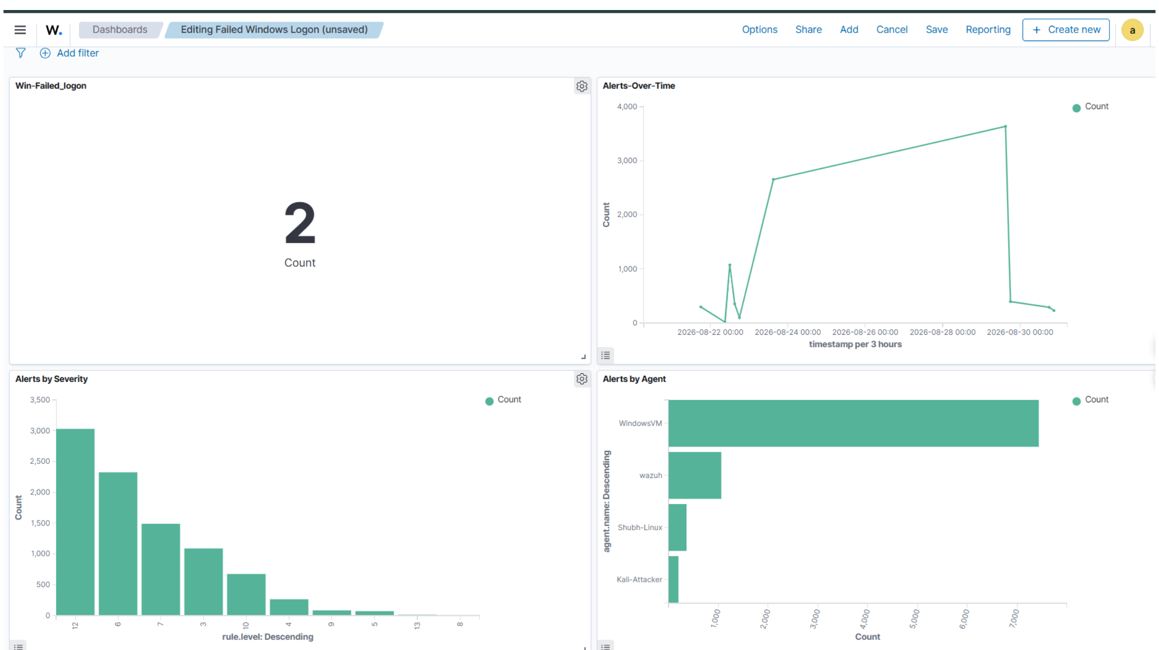

Figure 1: Wazuh dashboard — Failed Windows Logon, Alerts Over Time, Alerts by Severity, Alerts by Agent.

Observations from the dashboard

- Alert volume trend: A sharp spike in total alerts occurred between Aug 22–24, rising from a few hundred to nearly 4,000 before dropping off — worth investigating in a future session to identify what specifically drove that spike (likely tied to the account management testing from Day 1, plus any automated background activity).

- Severity distribution: The largest concentration of alerts sits at rule.level 12 (~3,000 alerts) and level 6 (~2,300 alerts), with a long tail down through levels 7, 3, 10, 4, 9, 5, 13, and 8. A level 12 concentration this large is worth a closer look — it likely reflects repeated instances of the same account-deletion-class rule from Day 1's testing rather than 3,000 distinct real incidents.
- Agent comparison: WindowsVM accounts for the overwhelming majority of alert volume (~7,000+), consistent with it being the primary target of manual testing so far. wazuh (the manager's own self-monitoring), Shubh-Linux, and Kali-Attacker each contribute smaller volumes — the presence of a Kali-Attacker agent in this view is a useful marker for upcoming attacker-simulation work.

2. Windows Event ID Deep Dive — Account Management

Queried Windows security events using DQL in Wazuh's Discover view and worked through the core set of Event IDs related to account lifecycle and privilege changes:

- **4720** — Account created
- **4722** — Account enabled
- **4723** — Password change attempt
- **4724** — Password reset attempt
- **4725** — Account disabled
- **4726** — Account deleted
- **4732** — Added to local security group
- **4733** — Removed from local security group
- **4738** — Account modified

Key insight: event sequences matter more than single events

A single event ID in isolation is rarely alarming — an account being created (4720) is routine IT activity. But a sequence of events happening close together tells a different story. Specifically:

4720 → 4722 → 4732

(account created → enabled → added to a privileged group)

This sequence, especially when it happens quickly and outside of normal provisioning workflows, is a pattern worth flagging for investigation. It mirrors a common attacker technique: create a low-visibility account, activate it, then quietly escalate its privileges — rather than compromising or modifying an existing, monitored account.

This is a core SOC analyst skill: moving from **raw log** → **filtered query** → **visualization** → **correlated sequence** → **investigation decision**, rather than treating every individual alert as an isolated data point.

Key Takeaways

- Dashboards turn scattered alert data into patterns that are actually visible — the severity and agent-volume charts surfaced trends (like the alert spike and WindowsVM's dominant share) that wouldn't have been obvious from scrolling through Discover alone.

• Event ID knowledge is necessary but not sufficient — the real analytical value comes from recognizing sequences of related events, not memorizing individual ID meanings.

• The 4720 → 4722 → 4732 pattern is now logged as a template "story" to watch for in future detection-writing work.